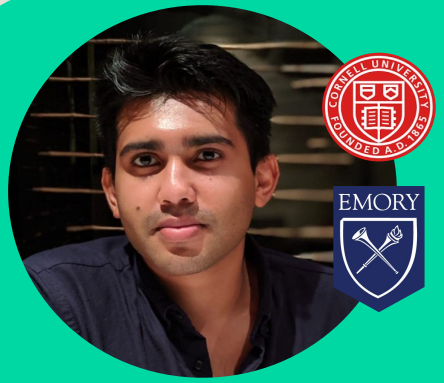
theApply.ai

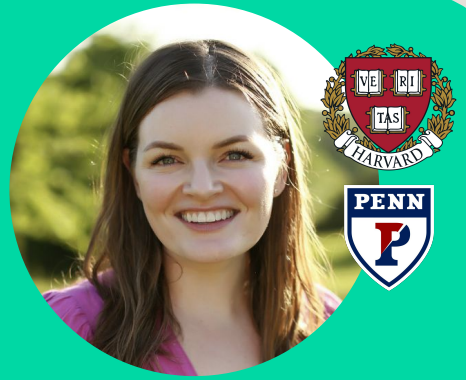
taking applicants from good to great

Who we are and why we're here



Vrijen Attawar
Co-founder & CEO

Cornell MBA
Ex-McKinsey
10+ years coaching



Logan Currie
Co-founder & COO

UPenn BA
Harvard Masters
15+ years coaching

theApply.ai

What we're hearing from people

"It's hard finding the right role."

"There are hundreds of applicants for a single role!"

"I have 2 decades of experience, but I'm still just a piece of paper in the end."

"I haven't been hearing back on applications and want to understand why."

"Ongoing layoffs in the tech industry have added a layer of uncertainty to my job search."

It’s not your imagination. Getting jobs has gotten harder!

- There were **~250 applicants on average** for corporate positions in 2023
- **75%** of applications get **excluded by ATS**
- Recruiters **judge** a resume **based on <10 seconds** of review
- **Referrals** make candidates **4x more likely** to get a job
- It takes **5 months on average** to **find a job** in 2023

You're extending your job hunt each time you ...

1. **Jump straight into applying for jobs** without doing enough groundwork
2. **Prioritize applying to "more" jobs** over applying more effectively
3. **Spend time redesigning** materials that <u>don't need</u> to be designed (*don't submit* Canva resumes or PDF's to application systems)
4. **Submit the same or similar materials everywhere** - regardless of role or company
5. **Are reluctant to network**, particularly through cold outreach
6. **Don't prepare for interviews** until he or she is invited
7. **Don't approach job hunting systematically** and with attention to detail

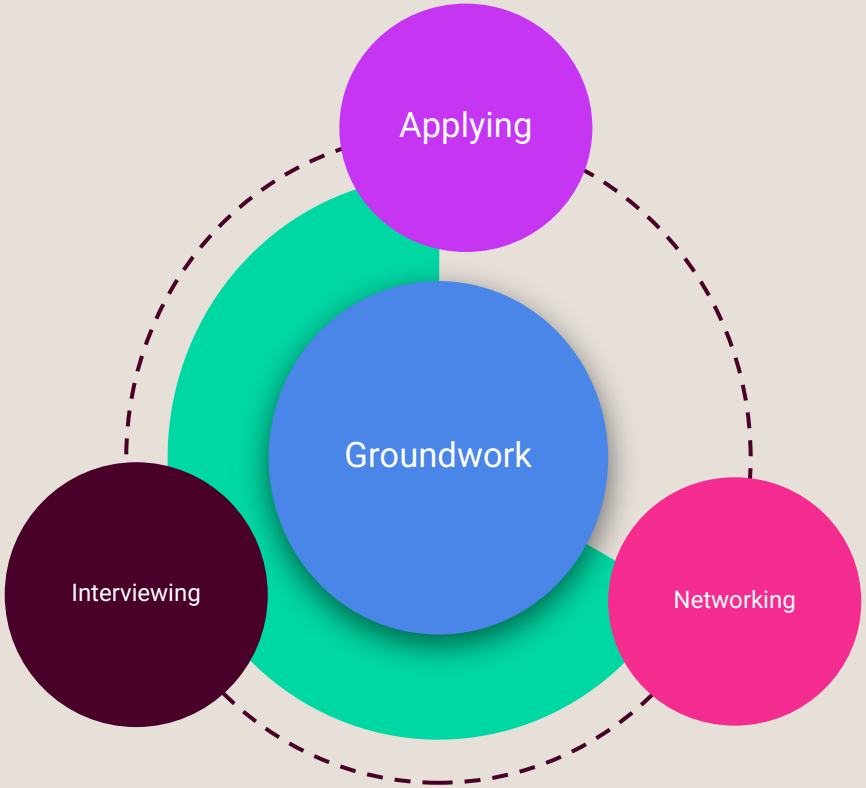
You're shortening your job hunt each time you ...

1. Apply to the **right jobs** and **present themselves in the right way**
2. Create **ATS and reader friendly materials tailored to the role** and company
3. Set yourself apart through their **knowledge of the company or the role**
4. **Improve your chances** of getting picked for interviews **by networking**
5. **Prepare** for a **variety of interview questions and situations**
6. Put in **consistent and systematic effort**

Eye-opening recruiting statistics

1. **61% of hiring managers** consider a **customized resume the number one tactic** for applicants to boost their chances
2. **54% of job seekers don't tailor their resumes** for each job or company, which recruiters perceive as a red flag
3. **65% of recruiters** recommend **sending applications within one to four days** of the job posting
4. The top resume deal breakers: **Typo/ bad grammar (77%)**, **Unprofessional email address (35%)**, **Lack quantifiable results (34%)**
5. **Employee referrals** were the **preferred sourcing channel for 82% of employers**

Your 4 levers for job search success



theApply.ai

Groundwork

What it takes

What do I have to offer? What do I want to get?

- **Personal**
  - What am I looking for from my next job?
  - What are the ways in which I want to grow professionally?
- **Work experiences**
  - What responsibilities have I fulfilled?
  - What impact have I had?
  - What skills and traits have I honed?

Networking & Cover Letters

Resume, Networking, Cover letters

Pro tip: *Take detailed notes that you can use to prepare materials*

Super pro tip: *Use The ApplyAI!*

Bottom line

You are the world authority on yourself - act like it!

Applying

What it takes

Targeted applying with tailored materials

- <u>Resume</u>
  - Does it show evidence I have at least 70%+ of **the required capabilities?**
  - Does 70%+ of my bullets include an **“impact metric” or “scale indicator**?
  - Does my skills section cover 70%+ of the **hard and soft skills stated or implied by the JD**?
  - Do I meet all the **required qualifications** and most of the **preferred qualifications**?

It should be obvious that the resume was prepared for this role

Pro tip: *Start with a master resume and “subtract” the irrelevant stuff*

Applying

What it takes

Targeted applying with tailored materials

- Cover letter
  - Does it include new information that doesn't repeat information on my resume?
  - Does it clearly show why I want to take on this role at this particular company?
  - Is it under ½ a page?
  - Is it addressed to the hiring manager?

It should be obvious that the cover letter was prepared for this role

Pro tip: *Cover the company name. If the cover letter reads like it could apply to any company, then it's not good enough*

Super pro tip: *Look at Glassdoor to get the inside scoop on a company*

Bottom line

Companies have more options than you

You won’t be taken seriously unless you show you’re serious about the role

Networking

What it takes

Reaching out to a person - like a person

- <u>The message</u>
    - Does it show that I've taken the time to research the person and their company?
    - Is it written in a friendly but professional manner?
    - Is there are clear ask at the end? (we recommend a 10-minute conversation to discuss the role and company)
    - Am I putting my best self forward? (LinkedIn)

It should be obvious that the message was written for that specific person

Pro tip: *Don't jump right into asking for a referral; have at least one conversation before asking them to put in a word*

Super pro tip: *ALWAYS ALWAYS ALWAYS send a "thank you" message the next day*

Bottom line

No one wants to waste their time

Most people want to help someone who comes off as professional, reliable, and enthusiastic

Interviewing

What it takes

Prepare flexibly

- Preparing
  - Do I have a polished 1-2 minute answer for “tell me about yourself?”
  - Have I thought through the anecdote for my key achievements?
  - Do I have answers about my strengths and my weaknesses?
- Practicing
  - Can I deliver answers without looking at a script?
  - Can I deliver answers while staring at myself on camera?

Pro tip: *Write out each anecdote in the START (Situation, Task, Action, Result, Takeaway) format*

Super pro tip: *Use The ApplyAI!*

It should be obvious that the message was written for that specific person

Bottom line

The best interview prep is knowing yourself inside and out

Q&A

This is your time!
What can we help with?

Thank you for joining us!

Date 1/24/2024

Vrijen Attawar

Admissions Counselor Vrijen Attawar shares a successful experience of mediating a conflict between a student and their parents, resulting in the student applying to both US and UK universities and becoming a strong advocate for their firm, leading to increased business and improved protocols for handling similar disputes.

Job title	EDIT	Test Prep Trainer
Company name	EDIT	The Keys Admissions
Start date	EDIT	End date EDIT

Elevator Pitch

COPY EDIT

"As a seasoned Admissions Counselor like myself, Vrijen Attawar, I not only facilitate the application process but also effectively mediate complex conflicts, like steering a student and their parents towards a mutually agreeable educational path within a tight schedule

With my strong knack for identifying common goals and leveraging excellent communication skills, I successfully enabled the student to apply to both US and UK universities, resulting in a five-star review and testimonial for my firm

In tricky situations, I'm all about resolution, satisfaction, and exceeding expectations

"

How can I use this?

LinkedIn Bio

COPY EDIT

Once an Admissions Counselor, now a 🌉 in complex situations

Effective at mediating conflicts, bringing resolution even in emotionally charged scenarios

Intimate understanding of education systems in both 🇺🇸&🇬🇧, with a knack for helping individuals make well-informed decisions🎓

Maintains firm focus on shared objectives, listening attentively and piecing together commonalities to drive 🤝

Instrumental in developing internal protocol for conflict resolution🧭

Satisfaction? You bet! Testament stands in 5-star Google reviews🌟and testimonials📜

Always on the lookout for opportunities to facilitate critical decisions and shape futures 🗺️! Onward to the next challenge in the same sector

How can I use this?

Responsibilities

COPY EDIT

- Mediating conflicts between students and parents regarding university choices
- Developing internal protocols for handling disagreements and sharing learnings with peers

How can I use this?

Recognitions

COPY EDIT

- The student gave us five stars on Google and wrote a testimonial in support of my firm and the work that I had done with him.
- The student became a huge advocate for us and posted about us on social media several times, bringing in several tens of thousands of dollars worth of business.

Soft Skills Mentioned

COPY EDIT

Mediation | Communication | Conflict resolution | Adaptability | Influencing | Empathy | Protocol development

How can I use this?

Metrics

COPY EDIT

- Time taken to resolve the conflict: about a week
- Student's satisfaction rating: five stars on Google
- Business brought in by student's advocacy on social media: tens of thousands of dollars
- Development of internal protocol for handling similar disagree

FEEDBACK

If you want to try our tool

SCAN ME

www.retro.theapply.ai

If you want a copy of the slides

Email vrijen@theapply.ai

Average # of applicants for a corporate role: **250**

Avg # of candidates interviewed: **5**

There has been a **40%** increase in avg applications per candidate - **just in 2023**

theApply.ai